



FOOD FROM THE NEW WORLD

From 1492 onward, European explorers sailed across the Atlantic to what they called the New World of North, Central, and South America. There they discovered a treasure trove of gold and silver. But they found other treasures, too. These were foods that grew only in the New World, such as sweet corn and potatoes, and plants that could be made into medicines. In fact, you may be surprised to find out how many of the foods you eat come from the New World. Every time you eat a tomato, or mashed potatoes, or have chocolate for a treat, just think, you owe them to the people of the Americas.



A world of golden treasure

The Native Americans had vast quantities of gold which they used to make into jewelry. The Europeans plundered most of this treasure.



Sunflower



Cocoa



Corn was eaten boiled or roasted, or ground into flour.

The explorer Christopher Columbus took it back to Europe when he returned from his voyages.

This is cornmeal, made out of ground corn. It was used to make breadlike foods.